

KIT 1 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF

AI Foundations & Safety: The One Hard Rule

Everything you need to know before you present this session. Read this guide once (about 10 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist on page 2, and you're ready.

What this session is

This is your staff's first structured hour with AI: what these tools actually are, what they're genuinely good at, where they fail, and the single privacy rule that keeps every educator in your building safe: **never put student personally identifiable information into a public AI tool**. Staff spend 15 minutes hands-on with a real AI tool and leave with prompts they can use tomorrow.

It is **not** a sales pitch for AI, and it is not a scare session. The tone is a respected colleague saying: this is a powerful tool, here's how to use it without risking your students or your job.

Who should present it

Any confident colleague: an instructional coach, a teacher-leader, a media specialist, an AP. **You do not need to be an AI expert**. The script is word-for-word; suggested answers to the questions staff actually ask are included. If someone asks something beyond the script, the honest answer, "Good question. Let's find out together," models exactly the culture this session is building.

Nervous? Read this. First-time facilitators run this session well because the deck carries the structure and the script carries the words. Your job is pacing and warmth, not expertise. If you can read aloud and keep time, you can deliver this session.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
Welcome & why now	0:00–0:04	Framing + three fast statistics
What AI actually is	0:04–0:12	Prediction, not lookup; strengths and failure modes
The One Hard Rule	0:12–0:22	Student PII: what counts, why it matters
Safe practice	0:22–0:30	Unsafe → safe prompt rewrites; de-identification moves
Hands-on lab	0:30–0:45	Pairs use a real AI tool with safe starter prompts
Staying human + norms	0:45–0:52	Review-everything rule; honest limits; 3 commitments

First 48 hours & close	0:52–0:55	Action sheet + exit ticket
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Core session is 55 minutes. Running a 45-minute slot? Cut the second lab task (slide 22) and shorten the debrief; the script marks both. A 60-minute slot absorbs discussion overflow.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

Do this the day before, or the morning of. Total time: about 15 minutes.

- ☐ **Skim the script once** (5 min). You'll read it aloud during the session; this pass is just so nothing surprises you. Mark where you'll personally add a sentence, if anywhere.
- ☐ **Open the deck and click through it** (3 min). Confirm all 30 slides display and you know how to advance them on the room's screen.
- ☐ **Pick the AI tool for the lab** (2 min). Use whatever your district has approved. If nothing is approved yet, any major free chatbot works for this adults-only lab (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Copilot); participants use their own accounts and type *no student information*, which is the very rule the session teaches.
- ☐ **Print the three handouts** (3 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours sheet, and Exit Ticket, one of each per person.
- ☐ **Send the one-line staff email** (2 min): "Bring a charged laptop or phone to Friday's PD. You'll be using an AI tool hands-on. No prep needed."

Room & tech setup

You need

- Projector or large display for the deck
- Wi-Fi that staff devices can join
- Seating that allows pairs (tables beat rows)
- Printed handouts × staff count
- A visible clock or timer

You don't need

- An AI expert in the room
- School accounts for an AI tool
- Any student data (the session never touches it)
- A second facilitator (helpful, optional)
- Perfect Wi-Fi (see Troubleshooting)

Timing discipline

The script prints a running clock next to every slide. Two checkpoints matter most:

- **0:22: you should be starting the safe-practice segment.** If you're behind, shorten discussion on slides 11–13; the content repeats in the handout.
- **0:30: the lab must start.** The hands-on quarter hour is the heart of the session. Protect it. Cut discussion before you ever cut the lab.

The one thing that makes this session land: staff actually typing a prompt into a real tool with their own hands. Everything else supports that moment.

Facilitator FAQ

"What if someone is hostile to AI?"

Welcome it. Skepticism is a feature of this session, not a problem. The deck itself names AI's real failure modes (fabricated citations, generic output, over-reliance). Say: "You may be the most important person in this room, because every school needs staff who push back. Today isn't about loving AI; it's about being safe and informed either way."

"What if someone already uses AI daily and is bored?"

Deputize them. Ask them to float during the lab and help neighbors who are stuck. And tell them up front that the privacy segment is still for them: the more someone uses AI, the more habits they've built without ever checking them against a rule, and the sneaky-PII examples on slide 12 catch experienced users all the time.

"What if I'm asked whether our district allows AI use?"

Answer only what you know is true. If your district has a policy, state it. If it doesn't, say: "That's genuinely unresolved here. Today's rule is the floor that's safe everywhere: no student personal information in public tools, and a human reviews everything before it reaches a student or parent." Note the question for your admin; it's the strongest possible argument for Kit 15 (the acceptable-use policy workshop).

"What if someone asks a technical question I can't answer?"

"I don't know — let's find out" is a complete answer. Write the question on the board, and put it to the room during the lab: someone can ask an AI tool and the group can judge the answer together. That's the whole skill this curriculum builds.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Wi-Fi fails during the lab	Pairs share any device with a signal; if all else fails, run the lab on the projector: you type, the room directs you. It works surprisingly well.
A tool requires sign-up and stalls people	Pair the stalled person with a neighbor who's already in. Never spend session time on account recovery.
An AI answer is wrong or weird on screen	Celebrate it: "This is exactly what slide 6 was about." A live failure teaches the verification habit better than any slide.
Discussion runs hot on student cheating	Park it visibly: "That's Kit 5 in this series; today is about <i>our</i> use, not students'." Note interest for your admin.

You're running 5+ minutes
behind at 0:30

Run one lab task instead of two and trim the debrief to two voices. End on time;
ending late costs you goodwill for the whole series.

After the session: 5 minutes

- Collect exit tickets; they double as your school's PD documentation.
- Skim the "one worry" column and pass themes to your admin; it sets up the 30-day plan.
- Put the three follow-up activities from the 30-Day Plan on your PLC calendar now, while the room is booked.

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